

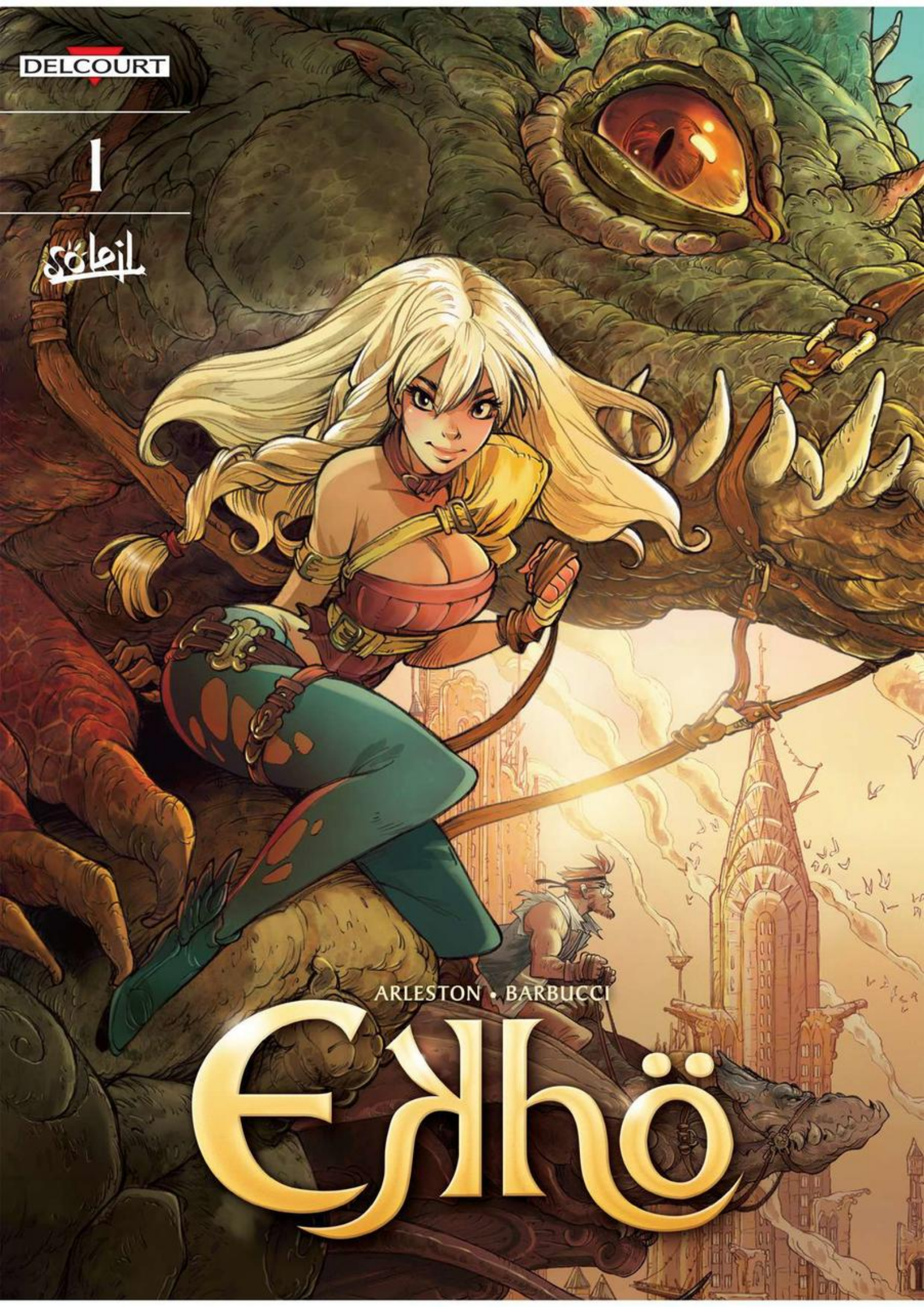
DEL COURT

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soleil

ARLESTON • BARBUCCI

Enhö





EKHO
New York

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EKHO IS THE EARTH, EXCEPT IT'S NOT.



Here we find the same cities, the same countries, but everything's different - it's a world without electricity. One may be born here, or brought in from Earth by some funny little creatures, the Preshauns. Nobody knows exactly what the Preshauns want...



But Fourmille and Youri's arrival is going to upset the balance kept by the Preshauns. Possessed by ghosts, Fourmille must solve their problems in order to go back to being herself again... For when she changes hairstyle, it's a sign she is inhabited by another personality...



FOURMILLE GRATULE

was flying to New York when she tumbled on Ekho. An inheritance was waiting for her and she's now the head of a talent agency.



YURI PODROV

a computer guy, was Fourmille's seat-mate on the plane. He's been accidentally dragged to Ekho with her. Usually their personalities are hardly compatible.



GRACE LUMUMBA

she is a native to Ekho. Loyal secretary of the Gratule Agency. In her spare time she's Yumma the stripper.



SIGISBERT DE MOTAFIUME

this Preshaun is a young clerk. His mission is to make sure that the presence of Fourmille and Youri doesn't affect the delicate balance of the mirror world too much!



THE PRESHAUNS

are strange and well mannered little creatures who ensure the proper functioning of Ekho; by using strange machines, they keep what they call the Thaumic equilibrium. They have to drink tea at specific times of the day, otherwise they might turn into dreadful, out of control, monsters!



LONG DISTANCE FLIGHTS ALWAYS HAVE A FEELING OF UNREALITY. THE CONTENTMENT OF FLYING OVER A SEA OF SOFT CLOUDS. THE QUIET HUMMING OF THE ENGINES...



QUIET HUMMING ALWAYS PUT ME TO SLEEP.



LADES AND GENTLEMEN WE HAVE JUST BEEN CLEARED TO LAND AT NEW YORK'S JFK AIRPORT...



PLEASE MAKE SURE YOUR TRAY TABLES ARE IN THEIR FULL UPRIGHT POSITION AND YOUR SEAT BELT IS SECURELY FASTENED...

MMH...



??



MISS FOURMILLE GRAYLUE?



OH... YES? WHAT... WHAT ARE YOU? WHO?



SIGSBERT OF NOTAFUME.

AT YOUR SERVICE.





HAVE A NICE DAY, MISS.

WHAT'S THAT STORM?

DUNNO CAPTAIN!



LADIES AND GENTLEMEN PLEASE STAY CALM IT'S JUST TURBULENCE...

EEEEEEK



AYAY!

WE'VE LOST CONTROL!

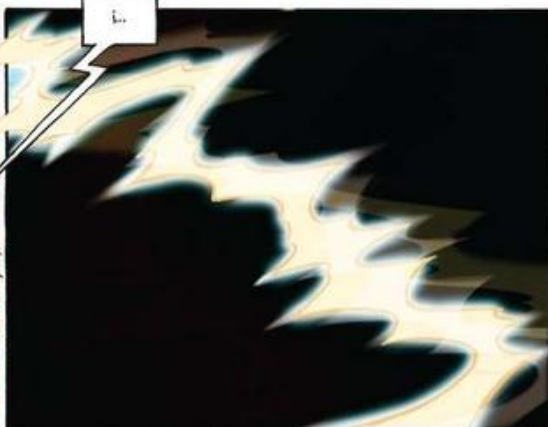


WE'RE GONNA DIE!

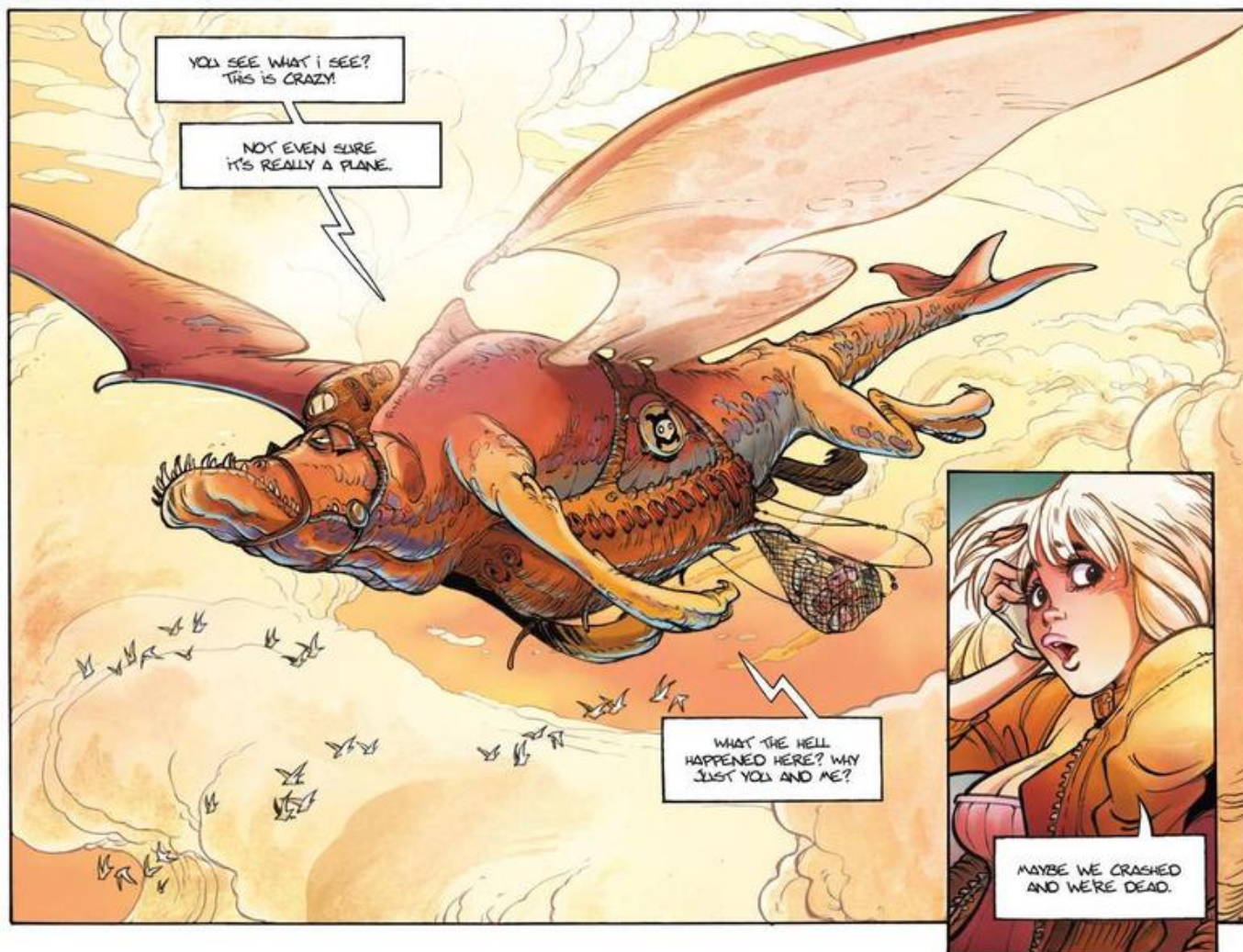
MISS FLYING IS THE SAFEST WAY TO TRAVEL...



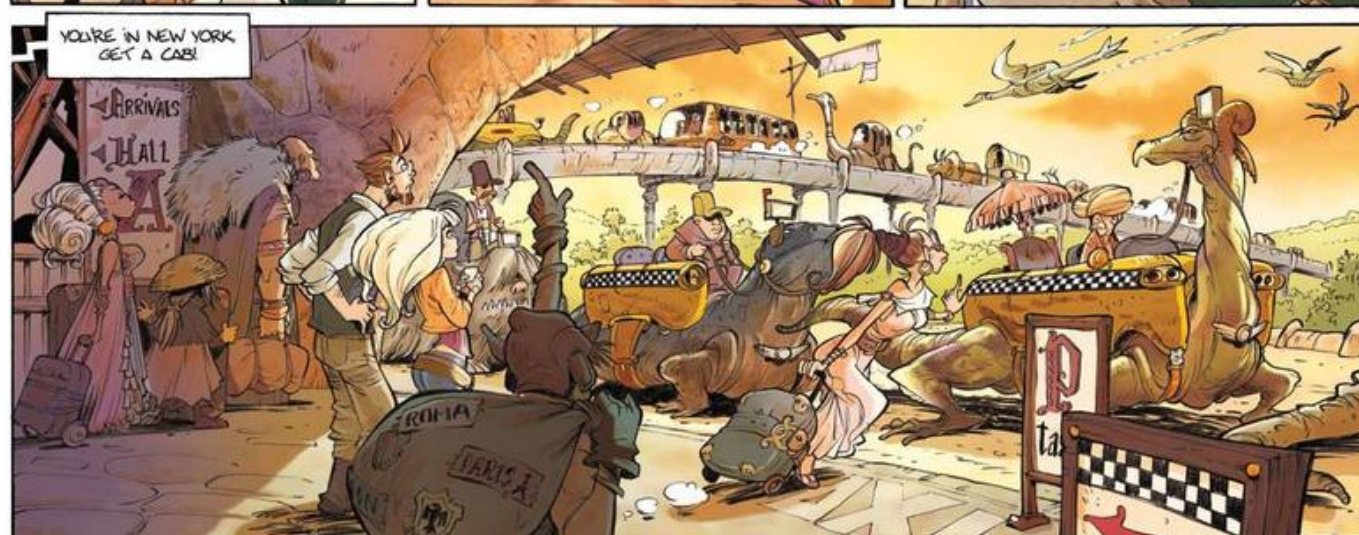
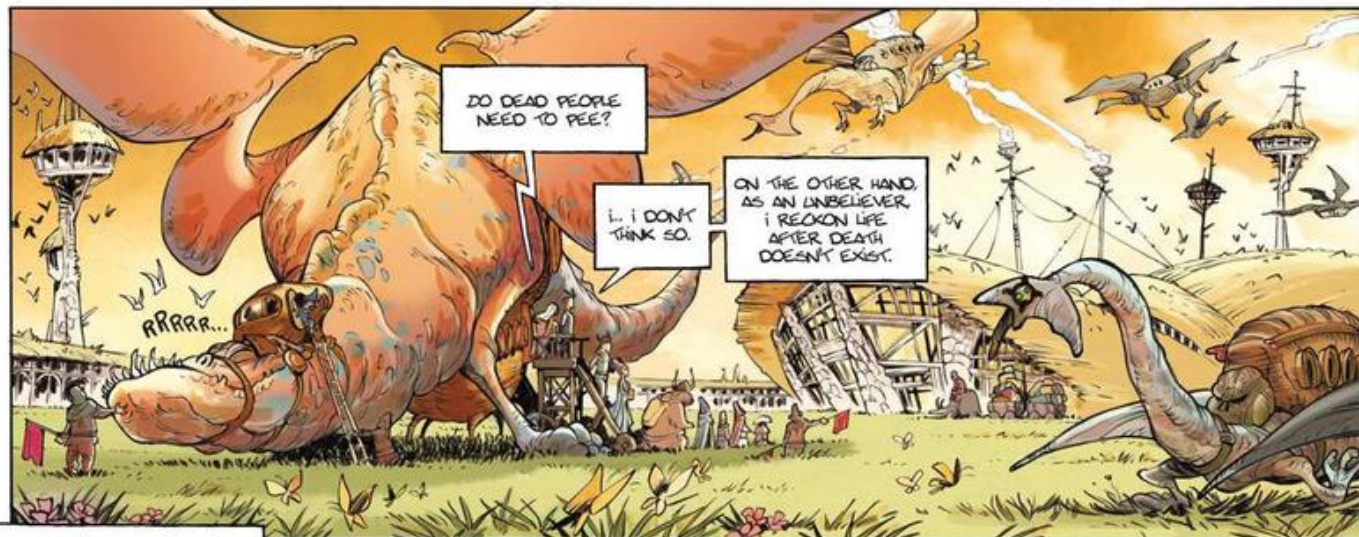
NOT TODAY!



...









OH THANK YOU OFFICER, SO KIND OF YOU! LET'S GO!

GO, GO!



WHAT THE? AND THE LUGGAGE?

SHUSHSHUSH!



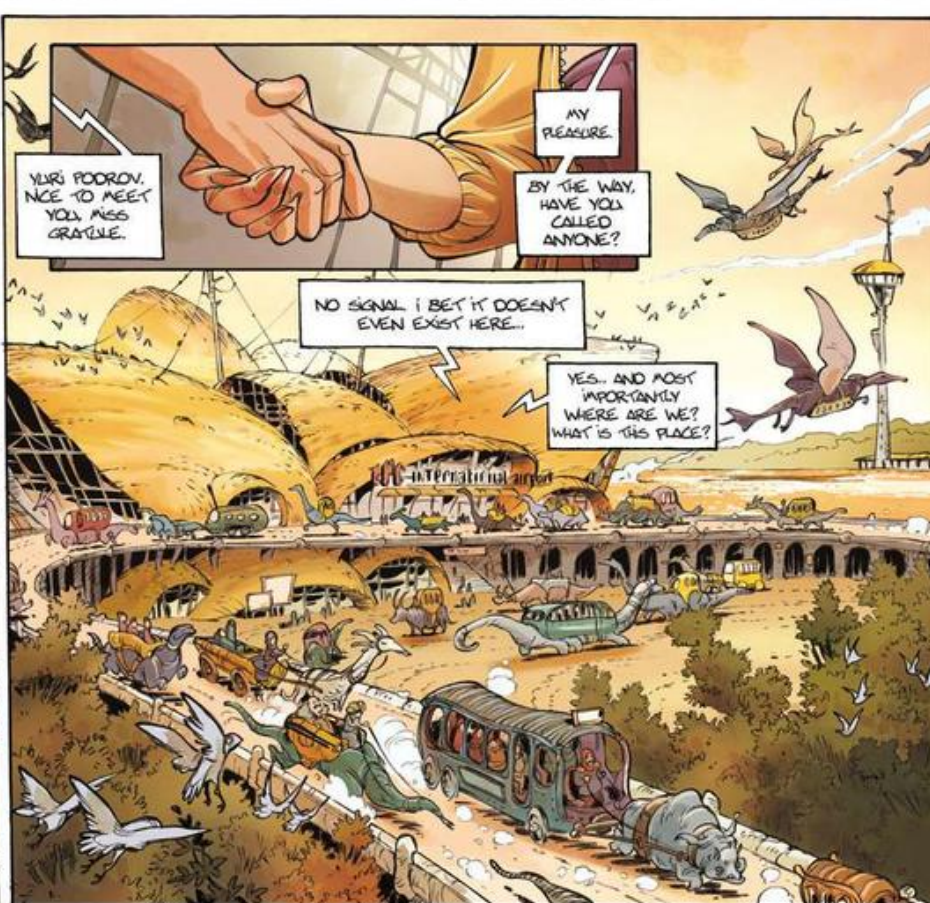
I JUST GOT RID OF THAT SUSPICIOUS COP, SO THE LEAST YOU COULD DO IS THANK ME.

GRAT GRAT



WELL... THANK YOU THEN... I DON'T EVEN KNOW YOUR NAME...?

FOURNILLE GRATULE... I KNOW IT'S NOT COMMON BUT I GUESS IT AMUSED MY PARENTS...



YOUR POORON, NICE TO MEET YOU, MISS GRATULE.

MY PLEASURE.

BY THE WAY, HAVE YOU CALLED ANYONE?

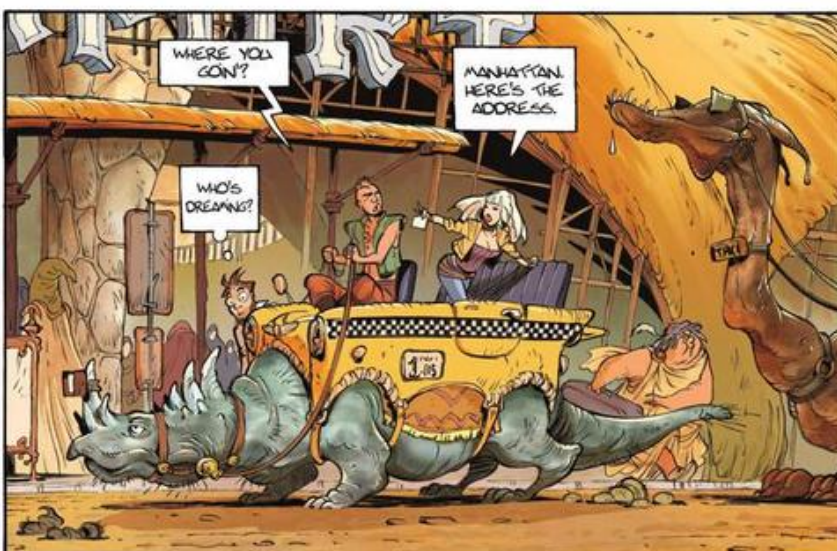
NO SIGNAL I BET IT DOESN'T EVEN EXIST HERE...

YES... AND MOST IMPORTANTLY WHERE ARE WE? WHAT IS THIS PLACE?



THERE'S A SIMPLE EXPLANATION WE'RE ASLEEP IN THE PLANE AND THIS IS JUST A DREAM.

AHH... BUT WHO'S DREAMING? YOU OR ME? WHO'S GOT INTO THE OTHER'S DREAM?



WHERE YOU GOIN'?

MANHATTAN, HERE'S THE ADDRESS.

WHO'S DREAMING?





BAGPIPES!
NEWCOMERS!

PEOPLE WHO ARRIVE WITHOUT
KNOWING WHERE THEY ARE
AND TAKE A CAB EVEN
IF THEY'RE FLAT BROKE...

AH YES...



DON'T WORRY, I'VE GOT JUST
WHAT YOU NEED. SOME GOOD
DOLLARS NOT EUROS.



WORTHLESS PIECES
OF PAPER FLOCK
I KNEW IT!

I WANT GOLD! WELL
SILVER AT LEAST.



OR MAYBE, WE CAN
MAKE A DEAL...



THE YOUNG LADY COULD
SHOW ME HER BOOBS,
FOR INSTANCE.



HEY! WHAT'S WRONG WITH YOU???



IF THIS
IS YOUR
DREAM
IT'S REALLY
SOB!

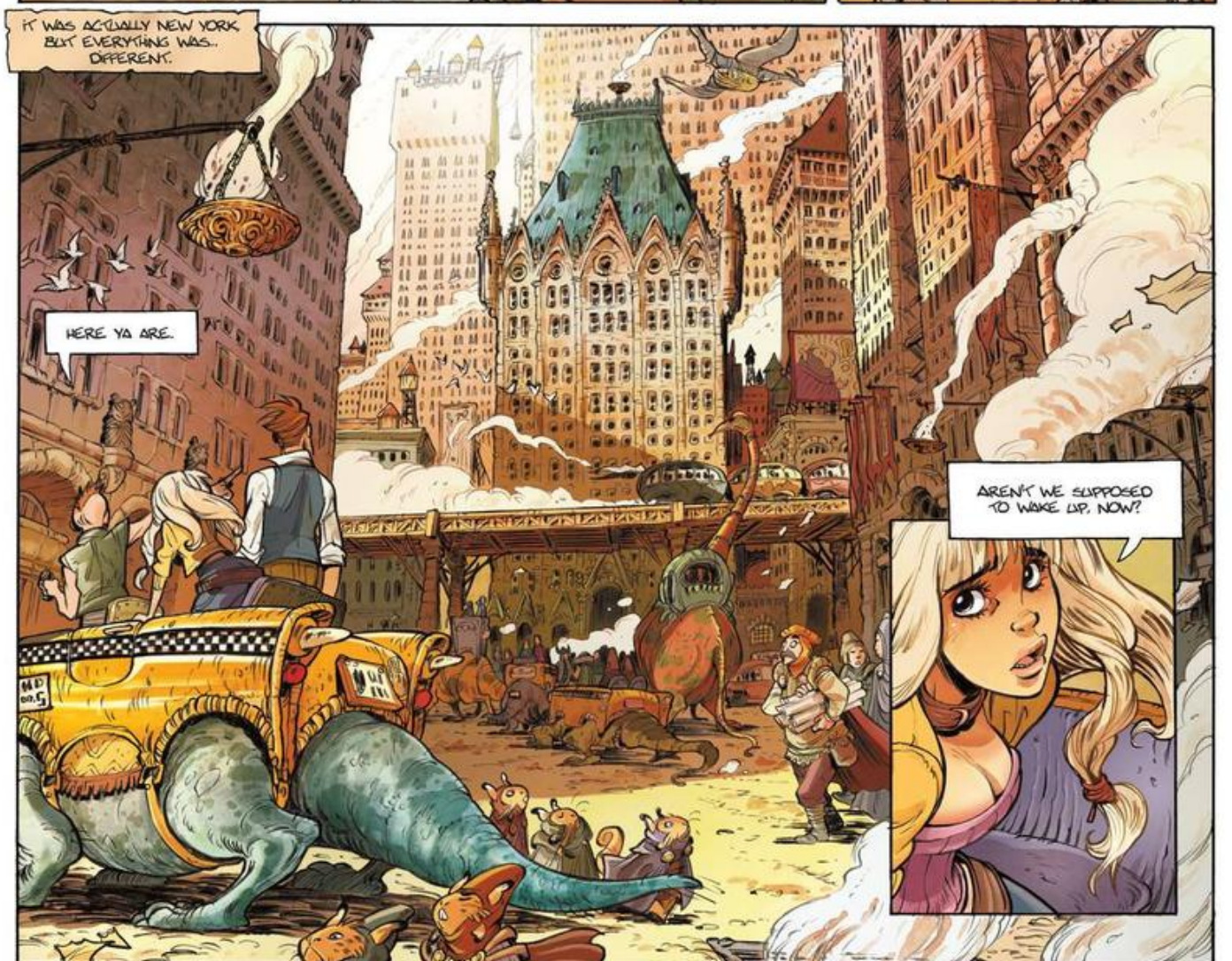
HEY, IT'S NOT
MY FAULT!

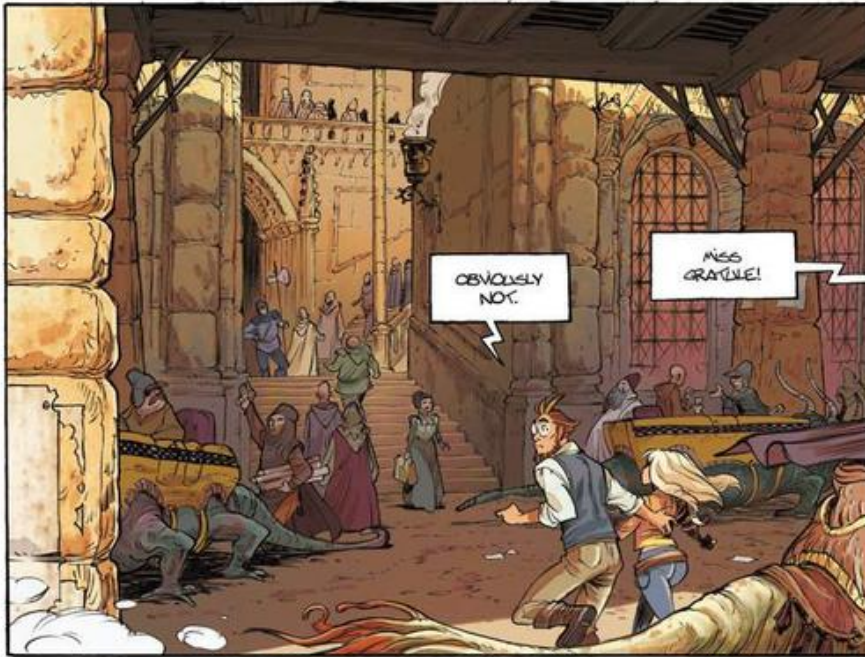


NO MONEY,
AND NOT EVEN
A RIGHTFUL
REWARD...

I'M CALLING
THE COPS.

WAIT!





WE'VE DISCOVERED THE FLOORS RESERVED TO THE PRESIDENTS. EVERYTHING IS SMALLER AND YOU HAVE TO MOVE IN THE MIDDLE OF FURNITURE THAT MAY HAVE BEEN DESIGNED FOR CHILDREN. AND YET, A GREAT SOLEMNITY COMES FROM IT, A SERIOUS AND IMPRESSIVE LOOK.



SO, THIS IS THE LITTLE FOURMILLE...

ERA... YES...

NECE OF ODELAIE GRATILE... YOU LOOK A LOT LIKE YOUR AUNT, MISS.

YOUNGER OF COURSE.

AND LESS DEAD, TOO.



LISTEN, I DON'T UNDERSTAND ANY OF THIS. WHY ARE YOU TALKING ABOUT MY AUNT? AND, MOST OF ALL, WHERE ARE WE?



YOU ARE IN EXHO. THE MIRROR WORLD. THIS PLACE IS ALWAYS A SHOCK FOR HUMANS COMING FROM THE OTHER SIDE, BUT YOU'LL HAVE TO GET USED TO IT.

FROM NOW ON YOU'RE GOING TO LIVE HERE.



BUT I DON'T WANT TO! MY WHOLE FAMILY AND ALL MY FRIENDS ARE IN PARIS! I WANT TO WAKE UP!



YOU'RE CONTROLLING THIS DREAM, AREN'T YOU? WHO ARE YOU? WHAT DO YOU WANT?

I COULD ASK YOU THE SAME, SIR.



I WAS EXPECTING MISS GRATILE ALONE, TO DEAL WITH THE SUCCESSION MATTER.

SIGSBERT, CAN YOU EXPLAIN?





AHEM... IT LOOKS LIKE MISS GRATULE GRABBED HER NEIGHBOR'S ARM DURING THE TRANSFER AND... HERE'S THE RESULT.



AN ACCIDENTAL ARRIVAL BY CONTACT! THAT'S EXTREMELY REGRETTABLE! SISBERT, YOU'LL HAVE TO PRODUCE A REPORT, FOUR COPIES!

THERE ARE RULES!



LISTEN, THIS IS BOTHERING US AS MUCH AS YOU, SO JUST SEND US BACK HOME AND EVERYBODY'S HAPPY, OK?

I'M AFRAID IT'S IMPOSSIBLE!



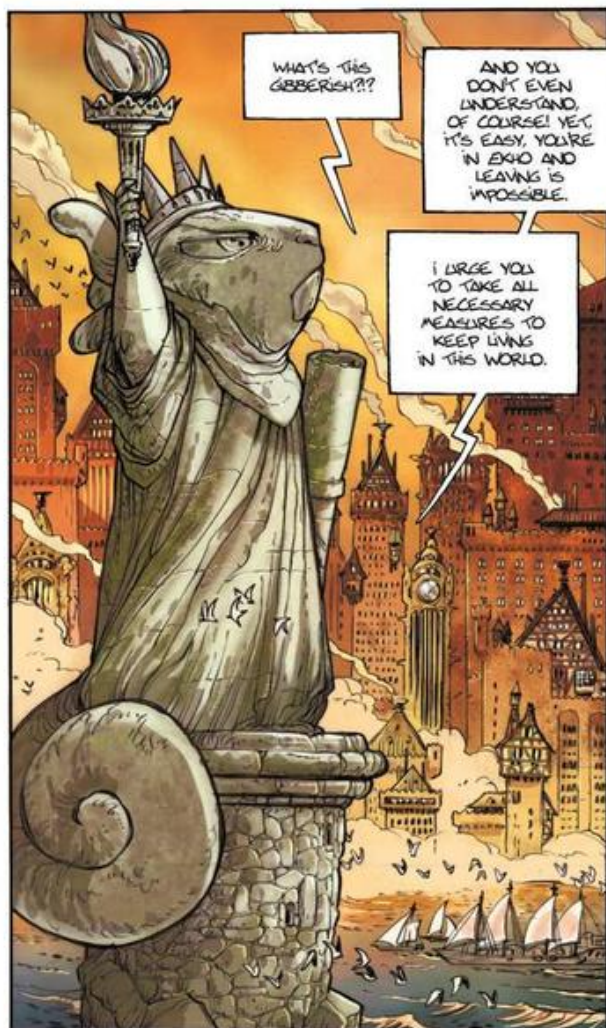
IT'S OBVIOUSLY YOUR DREAM I'VE ALWAYS THOUGHT PARALLEL UNIVERSE STORIES WERE LAME.

PPPP!



SIR ECHO IS NOT A PARALLEL UNIVERSE! IT'S THE PHILOPLASMATIC EXTENSION OF AN ALTERNATIVE REALITY THAT WAS BUILT AND SUSTAINED THANKS TO A PATIENT WORK OF THALMIC ENERGY!

SHOW SOME RESPECT FOR A WORK THAT HAS REQUIRED SUCH EFFORTS!



WHAT'S THIS GIBBERISH??

AND YOU DON'T EVEN UNDERSTAND, OF COURSE! YET, IT'S EASY, YOU'RE IN ECHO AND LEAVING IS IMPOSSIBLE.

I URGE YOU TO TAKE ALL NECESSARY MEASURES TO KEEP LIVING IN THIS WORLD.



WELL... NEVER MIND, I'M GOING TO WAKE UP ANY MINUTE NOW.



WE'VE WASTED ENOUGH TIME. IT'S NEARLY TEA TIME.

MISS GRATULE, HERE IS THE CONTENT OF THE INHERITANCE.



OH!

I WAS THE OWNER OF AN AGENCY. WHAT KIND OF AGENCY? TRAVEL? INVESTIGATION? I HAD A LOT OF QUESTIONS BUT I COULDN'T SAY ANYTHING THAT MADE SENSE.

"GRATITUDE AGENCY, DON'T GIVE UP EASILY."

THIS IS LAME!

YOUR AUNT WAS VERY PROUD OF HER MOTTO.

SIGN HERE FOR ACCEPTANCE.

WAIT A MINUTE, DOES THE ACCEPTANCE IMPOSE ANY OBLIGATION? DEBTS MAYBE?

NOTHING OF THE SORT. ODELAIE GRATITUDE WAS WISELY ADVISED BY THE TINTAGRELLE BANK REGARDING HER ASSETS.

THE BALANCES OF HER ACCOUNTS ARE ALL POSITIVE.

JUST SIGN, I HAVE TO ESCORT YOU OUT IMMEDIATELY!

I'M NOT SIGNING ANYTHING SO HASTILY. WOULD YOU PLEASE TELL ME WHY WE SHOULD LEAVE SO QUICKLY?

COME ON, IT'S TEEEEEA TIME!

WE PRESHAINS HAVE OUR LITTLE QUIRKS. TEA TIME IS A SACRED MOMENT REQUIRING MEDITATION.

TEEEEA! TEEEEEA! TEEEEEA!

THE INHERITANCE! ARE YOU SIGNING IT? YES? NO?

YES YES ALL RIGHT!

SCRITCH SCRITCH

IT'S TIME!

THE FIRST CONTACT
WITH FRESHMAN TEA
TIME CAN BE PRETTY
TRAUMATIC



WOW!

I DON'T KNOW TEA
COULD DO THIS!



I AM AT YOUR
DISPOSAL TO
ANSWER ANY
QUESTIONS.

BUT NOT
NOW. YOU
CAN LEAVE
BY THE
WINDOW.



BY THE
WINDOW,
OF
COURSE!

IT'S TEA TIME.
THE ELEVATOR SERVICE
HAS BEEN SUSPENDED.
YOU HAVE ONLY THE
OUTDOOR STAIRCASE.



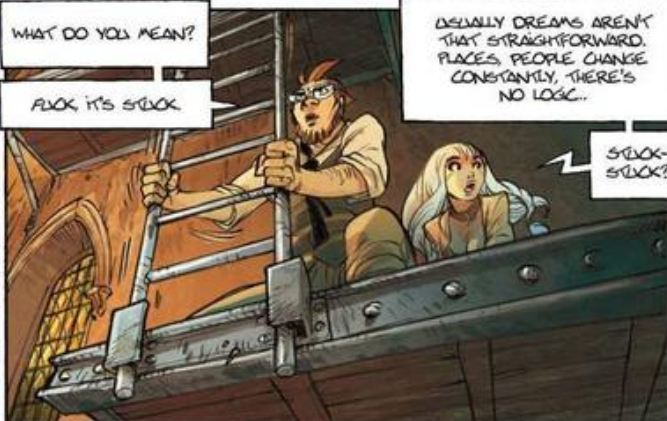
FOR A STUPID
DREAM, IT'S
REALLY STUPID!

I FEEL IT'S RUNNING
TOO LONG.



WHAT DO YOU MEAN?

FLUX, IT'S STUCK.



USUALLY DREAMS AREN'T
THAT STRAIGHTFORWARD.
PLACES, PEOPLE CHANGE
CONSTANTLY, THERE'S
NO LOGIC.

STUCK-
STUCK?

STUCK-STUCK

BECAUSE YOU FIND THAT
EVERYTHING IS LOGICAL
AND COHERENT HERE?

WELL, WE'LL SEE. IN
THE MEANTIME, YOU'RE
JUMPING OFF AND THEN
YOU CATCH ME, OK?









I WAS FEELING A LITTLE GUILTY FOR TELLING YURI TO GO TO HELL BUT IT WAS TIME FOR ME TO SEE WHAT WAS NEXT...



LAST FLOOR... WELL, AT LEAST THERE'S AN ELEVATOR!



?? THERE'S NOTHING HERE!



AH...



GREAT...



THIS WAY!

YOU MUST BE THE YOUNG MISS GRATITUDE?

?



GRACE LUMUMBA YOUR LATE AUNT'S SECRETARY AND CO-WORKER

FOURAILLE... ERA... IN FACT, I DON'T REALLY KNOW WHAT I'M DOING HERE.



IT'S NORMAL BAGPIPES ALWAYS FEEL A BIT LOST AT THE BEGINNING. I'M A NATIVE, SO IT'S THE OTHER SIDE THAT SEEMS STRANGE FOR ME.





I DON'T LIKE THE IDEA OF BEING DEAD, EVEN SOMEWHERE ELSE! BUT WHO EXACTLY ARE THOSE PRESNAUNS?





WHEN THE DAYS
DONE, IT'S TIME FOR
YUMMA TO GO OFF
TO WORK!

YUMMA? AH, YES...



TELL ME, BESIDES
THE OFFICE, IS THERE
AN APARTMENT?

MRS ODELAIE'S ROOM WAS IN
THE BACK OVER THERE... HER LITTLE
COSY CORNER, AS SHE USED TO SAY.



BOY... I SEE,
YES!

HOW COULD
SHE SLEEP
HERE?

I WOULD MAKE
A FEW TWEAKS.

LIKE THROWING
EVERYTHING
AWAY.



WELL THEN,
I'M GOING NOW.

WAIT! CAN I GO
WITH YOU?



IT'S MY FIRST DAY HERE,
I DON'T KNOW ANYONE...
I DON'T REALLY WANT
TO BE ALONE TONIGHT.

OK, LET'S
GO, THEN



SEE, YARE NEVER ALONE
HERE. IT'S KIND OF A
BROTHERHOOD, YEAH.



NIGHT!



GREAT...



NEW YORK.. NEW YORK.. THE SONG
HADN'T LOST A SINGLE TONE FROM
ONE UNIVERSE TO ANOTHER

EXCEPT I CAME TO SPEND
JUST A FEW DAYS AND ENDED
UP STUCK HERE, IN NEW YORK
NEW YORK!

START SPREADING THE NEWS
I'M LEAVING TODAY I WANT
TO BE A PART OF IT
NEW YORK NEW YORK!



AND I WAS SPENDING
MY FIRST NIGHT IN
THE BACKSTAGE OF
A NIGHTCLUB.

YEAH, I WANT YOU TO MEET
FOURMILE GRAYLE. SHE'S
GOING TO PUT THE AGENCY
BACK IN BUSINESS.

NICE TO
MEET YOU!

HURRY UP, GIRLS.
YOU'RE UP NEXT!



YA BROUGHT A FRIEND?
TO LEARN THE JOB?

GOOD IDEA.
SHE'S GOT
WHAT IT
TAKES.



HEA HEA

POF



MFFF



MY LITTLE
BORN
WHAT'S
WITH THE
INTIMACY?

HOW DARE
YOU TOUCH
INAPPROPRIATELY
OLD
COELALIE
GRAYLE?

BUT...
HEA...



I HAD ABSOLUTELY NO IDEA OF WHAT MIGHT HAVE HAPPENED TO YURI. AND, TO BE HONEST, AT THE TIME, I DON'T CARE AT ALL.



WAKE UP!



NIGHT HUNTING! ANY VOLUNTEER FOR A GOLDEN DOLLAR?

POK POK POK



THAT'S DANGEROUS!

I NEED MONEY.



YOU'RE NEW, EVER BEEN HUNTING?

ERM... I KNOW HOW TO THROW BIRDS AT GREEN PGS...



THAT'S GOOD, BUT FOR NOW YOU'LL JUST HAVE TO BEAT THE BUSHES WITH A STICK AND A LAMP WHILE SHOUTING.



WAIT! WHAT DOES IT PAY?

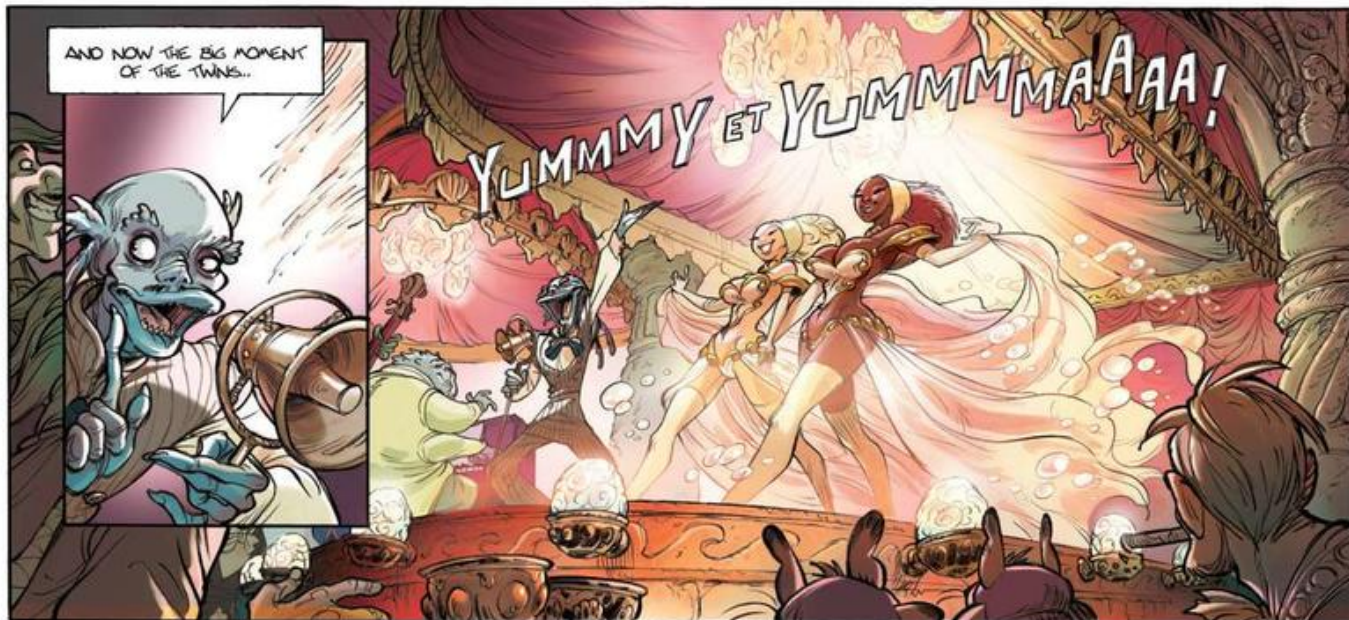
A BEATER GETS TWO PERCENT OF WHAT WE GET. IF YOU'RE LUCKY, IT CAN BE UP TO A SILVER DOLLAR.



YOU HAVE TO WALK STRAIGHT TO THE LAKE, THEN YOU GO AROUND IT, KEEPING TO THE LEFT AND TRYING TO BE AS LOUD AS POSSIBLE.

DON'T GO BEYOND THE LAKE, IT'S THE FORBIDDEN LAND.

GOY IT.









WHERE'S
THAT LAKE?



I'VE BEEN WALKING
FOR LIKE TWO HOURS...
I SHOULD BE ON
5TH AVENUE ALREADY!



STAY CALM, IT'S ONLY
CENTRAL PARK

KRRACK

HOOHOO
VRRZZ



WELL, CENTRAL PARK IS
A FLOCKING MAGIC WORLD,
WITH DIRTY DRAGONS,
LAWYER-SQUIRRELS AND
AN ENDLESS FOREST!

AND LOTS OF
STRANGE NOSES.



POWELL!
HUNTERS!
ARE YOU
THERE?



POWELL WON'T PAY ME,
I HAVE TO HUNT ALONE,
AND MOST OF ALL, I'VE
GOT TO FIND THE WAY OUT!



ONLY QUESTION
IS DO I ENTER
THE FORBIDDEN
TERRITORY?



WITH THIS, I CAN
FIGHT A BOAR!
WELL, AT LEAST
A RABBIT.

THERE'S NO WAY I'M WINNING
THE DARWIN AWARD BY DYING
LOST IN CENTRAL PARK!



Musical notes
YOU PROMISED ME BROADWAY
WAS WAITING FOR ME
YOU WERE HANDSOME
YOU WERE PRETTY...



Musical notes
AND THE BOYS FROM THE NYPD
CHOIR WERE SINGING GALWAY BOY...



Musical notes
AND THE BELLS WERE RINGING
OUT FOR CHRISTMAS DAY.













EARLY MORNING, BACK FROM THE NIGHTCLUB, SOMEWHAT PUNCH-DRUNK, AND THEY'RE WAITING FOR ME. REALLY NOT A GOOD TIME! ALL I WANTED TO DO WAS SLEEP!



THE TRANSITION FROM EARTH TO EXO IS STRICTLY REGULATED. EVERY PARTICLE HAS TO BE THERMALLY EQUILIBRATED TO PREVENT DAMAGE TO THE PHILOPSA.

WHAT DO YOU WANT FROM ME, SUGSBERT?

MISS GRAYLE, BY NOT KEEPING MR. POOROV WITH YOU, YOU'VE FAILED TO FULFILL YOUR RESPONSIBILITIES.

WHAT???

IT'S NOT MY FAULT!



DON'T PROTEST, NOBODY EVER UNDERSTOOD ANYTHING ABOUT THEIR STUFF...

I THINK THEY MAKE UP WORDS!



AS LONG AS THE ADJUSTMENTS REQUIRED BY MR. POOROV'S 'IRREGULAR PRESENCE' HAVEN'T BEEN HYDRODYNAMICALLY COMPLETED, YOUR TWO PHYSICAL MASSES MUST REMAIN CLOSE TO EACH OTHER.

TELL ME...



DON'T MASTER CLEOMANDER ASK YOU FOR A REPORT IN FOUR COPIES TO PREVENT THE PROBLEMS?

AHEA, THERE'S BEEN A LITTLE DELAY, AND, HUM... THE TIME, ALL THAT... THE ADMINISTRATION IS COMPLICATED...



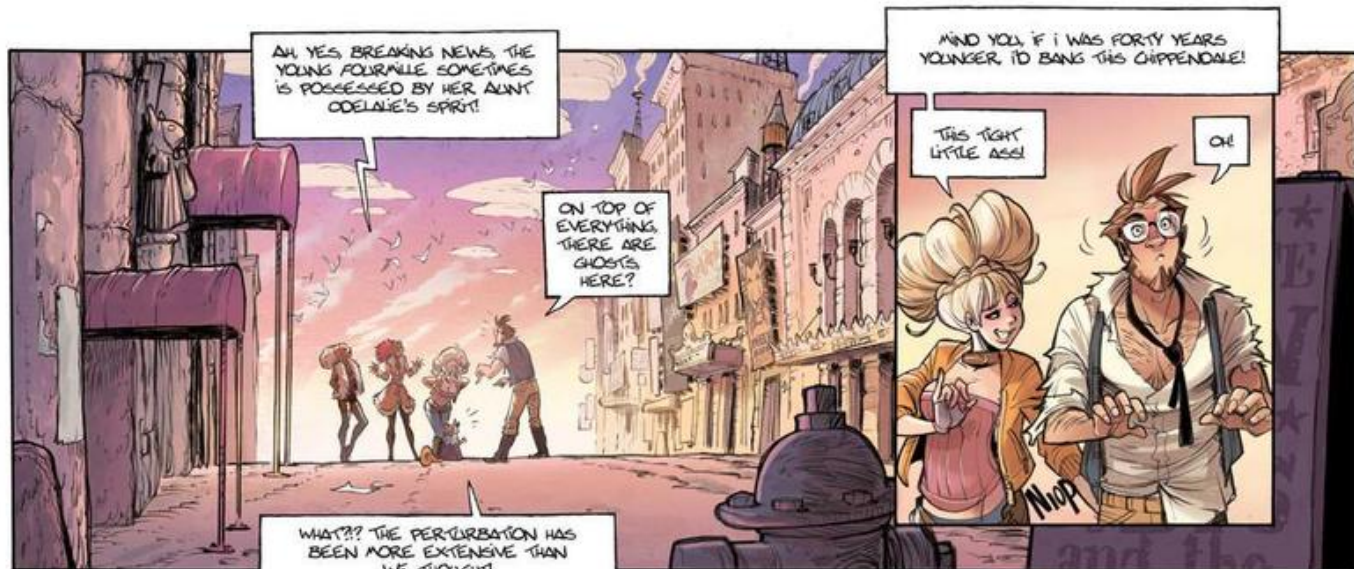
AH, I SEE! THE FUR BALL IS PATRONIZING US, BUT IT'S HIM WHO NEGLECTED TO DO THE JOB!



IT'S ALWAYS THE SAME WITH YOU, PRESHANK! YOU'VE BEEN TRYING TO RUIN MY LIFE FOR 40 YEARS!

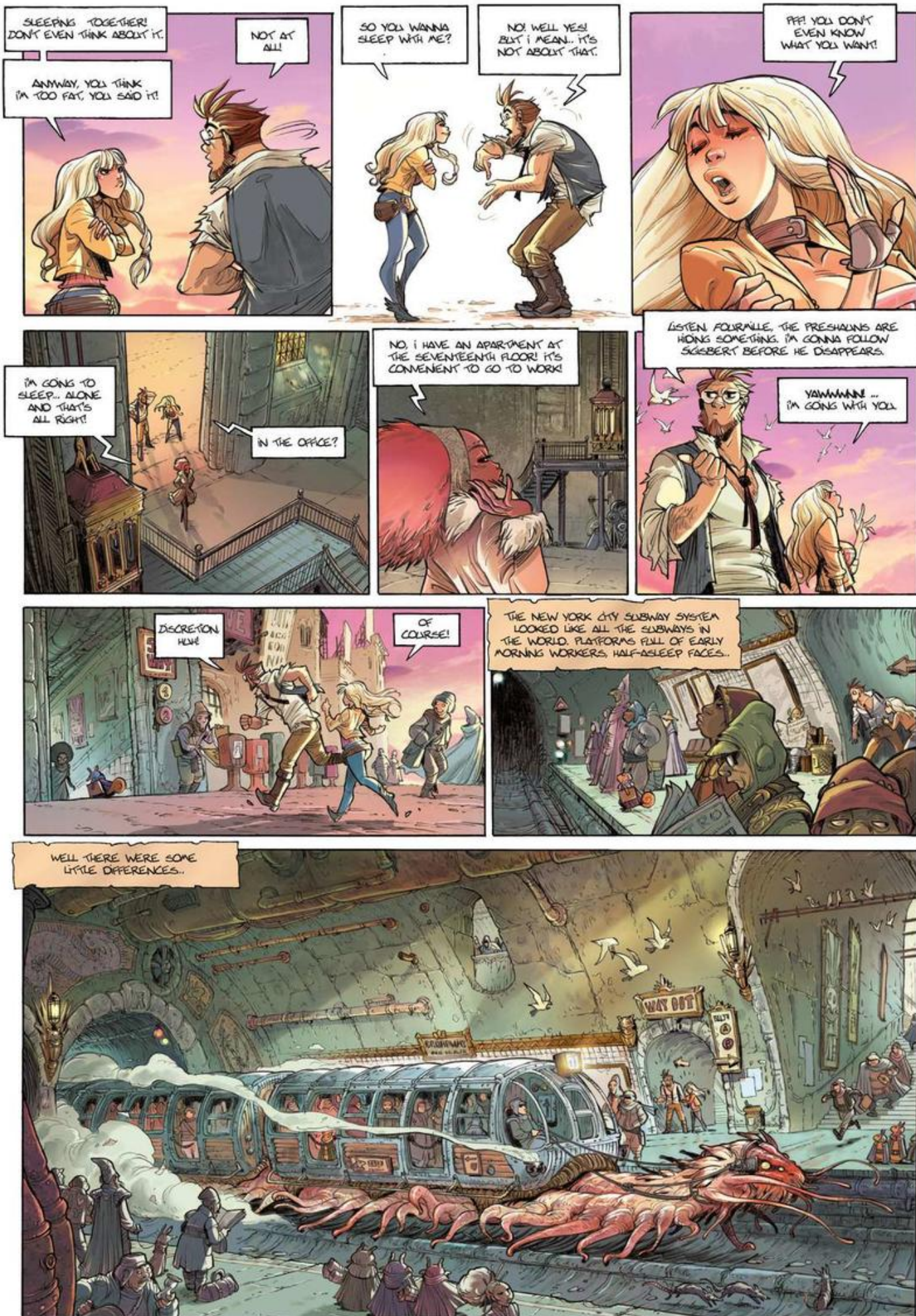
BUT...





















NO, CHINESE
GREEN TEA
THE STRONGEST.



